

“ It is not the least part of his humiliations to be convented in this point before such judges as Sergeant Crew, Sergeant Montague, and Sergeant Finch, the Attorney-General, (Bacon) and the Solicitor, (Yelverton) whereof the greater part, except the solicitor, are held no great men in law ; and withal to find such coarse usage as not once to be offered to sit down, and so unrespective and uncivil carriage from the Lord Chancellor’s men, that not one of them did move a hat, or make any other sign of regard to him ; whereof the Queen taking notice, his Majesty has since sent word that he would have him well used.”*

The Queen appears, at this time, to have favoured Sir Edward Coke very materially, probably through the influence of his lady.

On the 9th of November, 1616, Mr. Chamberlain told Sir Dudley Carleton, “ the Lord Coke hangs still in suspense, yet the Queen is said to stand firm for him, and to have been very earnest in his behalf, as likewise the Prince.”† Her noble exertions, we have seen,

* Nichol’s Progresses of James, vol. iii. 194. Birch MSS. 4173.

† Nichol’s Progresses of James, vol. iii, p. 226.

prevailed not, and Sir Edward Coke being suspended from his office, Mr. Chamberlain told his friends on the fourteenth of the same month, "the Lord Coke is now quite off the hooks, and order given to send him a supersedeas from executing his place.

"The common speech is that four P's have overthrown and put him down; that is, Pride, Prohibitions, Premunire, and Prerogative."*

In retailing this popular gossip, Chamberlain had evidently no ill feeling towards the late Chief Justice; for, on the following 23rd of November, when addressing his correspondent, he thus remarks upon his displacement:

"If Sir Edward Coke could bear his misfortunes constantly, it were no disgrace to him, for he goes away with a general applause and good opinion. And the King himself, when he told his resolution at the council table to remove him, yet gave this character, that he thought him no ways corrupt, but a good justice—with so many other good words, as if he meant to hang him with a silken halter.

"Hitherto he bears himself well, but especially towards his lady, without any complaint of her

* Ibid, vol. iii, p. 226. Birch MSS. 4173.

demeanour towards him ; though her own friends are grieved at it, and her father sent to him to know all the truth, and to show him how much he disallowed her courses, having divided herself from him, and disfurnished his house in Holborn, and at Stoke, of whatsoever was in them, and carried all the moveables and plate she could come by, God knows where, and retiring herself into obscure places, both in town and country.

“ He gave a good answer likewise to the new Chief Justice, who sending to him to buy his collar of S.S. he said he would not part with it, but leave it unto his posterity, that they might one day know that they had a Chief Justice to their ancestor.

“ He is now retired to his daughter Sadlers, in Hertfordshire,* and from thence, it is thought, into Norfolk.

“ He hath dealt bountifully with his servants ; and such as had places under him ; he hath willed them to set down truly what they gained, and he will make it good to them, if they be willing to tarry and continue about him.”†

* Ann Coke, married to Ralph, son and heir of Sir Thomas Sadler.

† Nichol's Progresses of James, vol. iii, p. 228. Birch MS.
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